



Sony HT-A3000 Soundbar

A recipe for success

The Sony HT-A3000 soundbar is one of those audio products that found a soft spot in everyone's heart at the Test Centre as soon as it showed up, and while we watched a few videos with the audio pouring out of this magnificent bar. The package that we received included the SA-RS3S rear speakers and the SA-SW3 subwoofer. Just to let you know, all the connections between the subwoofer, the rear speakers and the soundbar itself were wireless. All of it, put together, made for a great content-viewing experience.

What's in the box?

- Remote Control
- TV centre speaker mode cable
- HDMI Cable
- AC Cord
- Warranty Card
- Quick Setup Guide
- Instruction Manual

Build and Design

If you are someone who pays close attention to the looks of the product they are buying, then you are in luck with this one. The soundbar has a muted look, with the black plastic body carrying



a subtle Sony logo, some controls and a couple of tweeters, being complemented by the metallic front grill of the same colour. The subwoofer that we got had a leather-like finish to the body with a soft fabric covering at the front. The rear channel speakers carried the same finish as the bar and looked like they had been chopped off from the same product.

In terms of weight and portability, the setup was decent. The bar had a nice heft to it but was light enough for someone to move it around easily.

The mapping for the 360-degree Spatial Audio experience done by the soundbar, was smooth as well.

I/O and connectivity

The soundbar supports HDMI ARC and eARC, as well as Bluetooth connectivity. And, if you are someone who owns a Bravia TV, then you can use the S-Center speaker-in for a single cable audio con-

nection to your TV. There is an optical input port as well.

Performance



The Spatial 360-degree audio setup made sure that we got a theatre-like feel when watching movies like Top Gun: Maverick, which has a lot of surround audio elements in its scenes.

And, when it came to listening to music and podcasts, the soundbar held its ground. In movies and TV shows, we noticed that as soon as background music started playing, the vocals took a hit.

Here at Digit, we always look for the best out-of-the-box experience, so EQ tuning might help the soundbar work with vocals better. However, if you are someone who does not like taking a stroll into the settings menu often, then you might find the performance of this bar a bit underwhelming.



Verdict

The HT-A3000 soundbar, the rear speakers, and the subwoofer, put together, will cost ₹1,70,970. And, for that price, there are definitely multiple options for you to explore. However, if you are looking for a soundbar setup that will last you a while and provide great performance for the most part, then you cannot go wrong with the Sony HT-A3000.

—Sativik Pandey